

Five Minutes at a Table

Read across for the growth from working-towards to above. **Read down** from the marked words, to what they prove, to the continuum line. Only the words that do the work are marked. Everyone is a letter, nobody is a name.

🔊 Listening move

A clarifying question, or saying back what you heard before you answer it.

LISTENING 5 TO 9

marked like this

💎 Respond with a reason

Say how it hit you, agree or disagree, and give the reason. Naming who you are answering counts.

INTERACTING 5 AND 7

marked like this

“ Point at the words

A quote, a word, a line, or 'the bit where'. The evidence lives in the book, not in the vibe.

INTERACTING 7, LISTENING 8

marked like this

→ Bring someone in

Inclusive and encouraging language: asking a quiet person, going back to a dropped idea, handing over.

INTERACTING 10

marked like this

♪ Voice and body

Written in italics like stage directions. Volume, pace, pausing, looking at the person you answer.

INTERACTING 8 AND 9, PRESENTING 7 TO 11

marked like this

Same table, same quote, three levels

“I do not tell lies. Mother used to say that this was because I was a good person. But it is not because I am a good person. It is because I can't tell lies.”

Session 1 · Table 4 · Chapter 37

The prompt asks how the quote hit you, whether never lying is a strength or a problem, and whether a kind lie exists. Four people, five minutes. Each column is a different table having the same five minutes.

Working towards LEVEL 7	Expected LEVEL 9 · YEAR 9 EXPECTED	Above LEVEL 11			
😊 A A reads the quote fast, eyes on the page Okay so, he doesn't lie. <u>I think that's good.</u> 😊 B B <u>Yeah, same.</u> Lying's bad. 😊 C C <u>I felt a bit sorry for him</u> 'cause his mum said he was good and he's like, no I'm not. 😊 A A <u>I agree with C. He says it's because he can't,</u> not because he's good. 😊 D D ... 😊 B B <u>I reckon it's still good though.</u> Like, if you never lie, people trust you. 😊 C C <u>Wait, what do you mean by trust?</u> 😊 B B Like, they know you're not gonna, um, make stuff up. 😊 A A <u>looks at the clock</u> Are we done?	😊 A A reads the quote slowly, looks up at the end <u>My first reaction is that it's a bit sad, because he's correcting his own mum: 'it is not because I am a good person.'</u> 😊 B B <u>I felt the opposite, I found it funny, the way he splits hairs: good person versus 'can't tell lies'.</u> 😊 C C <u>So B, do you mean he's being funny on purpose, or we just find it funny?</u> 😊 B B Not on purpose. <u>He's dead serious, which is what makes it funny.</u> And a bit sad, <u>so I partly agree with A.</u> 😊 D D <u>I don't think it's sad. 'I can't tell lies' means he never has to decide. Honestly I'd find that easier.</u> 😊 A A <u>Can you say more about easier?</u> 😊 D D Like, we lie to be polite. <u>He'd just say the true thing about your haircut.</u> No stress. 😊 C C <u>I see it differently, because</u> the stress just moves to everyone else. <u>What do you think, B, you've been quiet a sec?</u> 😊 B B <u>I think C's right, and later in the book his honesty is exactly what gets him in trouble with the police.</u> 😊 A A <u>So do we agree it's a strength and a problem?</u> <i>waits</i>	😊 A A reads it twice, second time stressing 'can't' <u>It hit me as lonely, because 'I can't' is the only reason he gives, and the mother's kinder version gets crossed out.</u> 😊 B B <u>So you're saying he'd rather be accurate than be thought of as good?</u> 😊 A A Yes. <u>He'd rather be right about himself than liked.</u> 😊 C C <u>I'd push back a bit. He isn't rejecting 'good': he just can't accept a reason that isn't true. Which is kind of the most honest thing in the whole book.</u> 😊 D D <u>That's the part I couldn't disagree with more. Later he says a lie is 'when you say something happened which didn't happen', and he's fine with white lies because they're only leaving things out. So he's not as pure as this sounds.</u> 😊 B B <u>Where's that, roughly? The white-lies bit.</u> 😊 D D <u>Chapter 37, straight after this quote, is his definition of a lie. The white-lie bit comes a few chapters on, reads two lines</u> 😊 C C <u>Okay, that changes my view. 'Leaving things out' is what Father does about Mother, so Christopher's rule actually lets in the biggest lie in the book.</u> 😊 A A <u>D, you've clearly read ahead. What does that do to 'lonely'?</u> <i>leans back, hands the talk over</i> 😊 D D <u>It makes it worse, because his own definition is what lets Father get away with it. B, do you buy that?</u> 😊 B B <u>Mostly. Can we put that down as our one thing: his rule about lies is the plot?</u>	WHAT IT PROVES - One clarifying question (C), late and not followed up. - Opinions are given ('I think that's good') and two people name who they agree with, but reasons stay at 'lying's bad'. Feelings are expressed once. - One pointer at the words (A: 'he says it's because he can't'). Nobody reads the line aloud a second time or asks what 'can't' means. - D never speaks and nobody notices. The talk stops when the ideas run out, at about two minutes. - Reading is rushed and nobody looks up; the register is fine for friends but not adjusted for a discussion. LEARNING CONTINUUM Listening 7 · I can use active listening skills Interacting 7 · I can share my interpretations, ideas and opinions in a group discussion	WHAT IT PROVES - Two clarifying questions (C, A) that are answered, and B checks back to A's point before disagreeing with it. - Everyone states a feeling or a view with a because. Disagreement is explicit and polite ('I see it differently, because') and people move ('so I partly agree with A'). - Four separate pointers at the words. The quote is re-read, one phrase is contrasted with another ('good person versus can't tell lies'), and B links it to a later event. - C notices B has dropped out and brings them back. A closes by checking the group's shared view rather than just stopping. - The reader slows down and looks up. A pauses after a question instead of filling the silence. LEARNING CONTINUUM Listening 9 · I can listen critically to spoken texts constructed for different purposes Interacting 9 · I can change the use of my voice when presenting, discussing or persuading	WHAT IT PROVES - Listening is critical: B paraphrases to test A's claim, then asks for the location of D's evidence so the group can check it, and the group changes its view in response. - Positions are justified and revised out loud ('that changes my view'). Disagreement targets the argument, not the person, and the talk moves from feeling to interpretation to the novel's structure. - Evidence is precise: a stressed word, a contrast between two reasons, a second passage with its chapter, a definition quoted and tested against a character's behaviour. - Two hand-overs that are also questions. The last line turns the talk into a shared product for the write-up. - The reader re-reads with different stress to make a point. Leaning back and handing over is a deliberate change of register. LEARNING CONTINUUM Listening 9 · I can listen critically to spoken texts constructed for different purposes Interacting 10 · I can use inclusive and encouraging language to facilitate positive conversations
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The other two sessions, at the expected level, and one that isn't working

Session 2 · I couldn't disagree more

Ed Boone is a good father. B is the Reader at this table: they run the talk and hold their own view back.

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The marks are a taxonomy, not a score: a line can carry two moves, and a great five minutes does not need every colour in every line. What separates the columns is whether reasons are given, whether words from the book are pointed at, whether anyone checks what they heard, and whether the quiet person gets asked. Continuum lines are from the school's Speaking and Listening continuum; see the [rubric](#).